

Direct and indirect proofs



- 1 Sari wants to prove that $(a + b)^2 \geq 2ab$ for all integers a and b . Her proof is shown below:

$$\begin{aligned}(a + b)^2 &= a^2 + b^2 + 2ab \\ &\geq 2ab \quad \text{since } \mathbb{I}\end{aligned}$$

What should she write in the $\mathbb{I}$ to complete her proof?

- 2 Prove that $(x + y)^2 - 9(x - y)^2 = 4(2x - y)(2y - x)$.
- 3 Use the method of completing the square to prove that $x = \frac{-b \pm \sqrt{b^2 - 4ac}}{2a}$ for all quadratics of the form $ax^2 + bx + c = 0$.
- 4 If N is an even integer, prove that $\frac{N^2}{2}$ is an even integer.
- 5 Prove that angle sum of a straight line is 180° .
- 6 Prove that the sum of two consecutive numbers is odd.
- 7 Prove that $(a + 2)^2 - (a - 2)^2$ is divisible by 8 for any positive whole number a .
- 8 Prove that the sum of two consecutive odd numbers is an even number.
- 9 Prove that the distance between two points (a, b) and (c, d) is given by $\sqrt{(c - a)^2 + (d - b)^2}$.
- 10 Prove that if we subtract 1 from a positive odd square number, the answer is always divisible by 8.
- 11 Prove that $0.\dot{1}\dot{8}$ is a rational number.